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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 18

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Inscripción en un club de lectura

Organiser: Hello, Riverside Book Club, this is Peter speaking.

Customer: Hi there. I'd like to join the book club, if there are still places available.

Organiser: There certainly are. Let me take a few details from you. What's your name?

Customer: It's Laura Hammond.

Organiser: Before we go through the individual choices, I should explain how I handle a book-club registration. I will confirm your priorities first, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Customer: That approach is exactly what I need for the book-club registration. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Organiser: Could you spell your surname for me?

Customer: Of course - it's H-A-M-M-O-N-D.

Organiser: Thank you, Laura. And where do you live?

Customer: I'm at 8 Chestnut Close.

Customer: For this book-club registration, I am more concerned about reliability than an impressive description. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Organiser: Of course. In this book-club registration, I will make each trade-off explicit as we proceed, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Organiser: Chestnut Close, lovely. And a contact number?

Customer: My mobile is 077 2358 4190.

Organiser: Great. Can I ask how you heard about us?

Organiser: A book-club registration can involve names, dates and choices that sound alike when they are given quickly. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Customer: I will. For the book-club registration, it is useful to know which details are certain, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Customer: I saw a poster in the local library, actually.

Organiser: Wonderful. Now, what kind of books do you most enjoy reading?

Customer: I mainly read historical fiction, though I do enjoy the occasional biography.

Organiser: We read a real mix - the members vote on the book each month. Now, which evenings tend to suit you? We meet fortnightly.

Organiser: Let me finish the book-club registration by summarising what I have recorded. For this book-club registration, I will read back the information in order, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the book-club registration, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Customer: Good. During the book-club registration, I will listen carefully and check it against the notes I brought.

Customer: I was going to say Thursdays - actually, no, Wednesdays are better for me. I have a class on Thursdays.

Organiser: Wednesdays it is, then. And just so you know, we ask every new member to bring their favourite novel to their first meeting, so they can introduce themselves.

Customer: That's a lovely idea. And where do you actually meet?

Customer: Before we close the book-club registration, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Organiser: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Organiser: At the moment we meet in a room above the bookshop on the high street. There's plenty of parking nearby.

Customer: Perfect.

Organiser: Now let me explain the two membership options. Standard membership costs £25 a year. That includes two free books a year and a monthly newsletter with reviews and recommendations.

Customer: And the premium one?

Organiser: Before I close this book-club registration, I will separate the details we have confirmed from the points that remain optional. Please listen to the complete summary before responding, because correcting one item can sometimes affect a later choice as well. I will keep the original order so that it is easy to compare with your notes.

Customer: That is helpful. I will check each detail as you read it and ask about anything that does not match what I intended. Once the summary is accurate, I will also note the reference and the method for making a later amendment.

Organiser: Premium membership is £45 a year. You get six free books a year instead of two, and premium members can also attend our free writing workshops.

Customer: The premium sounds well worth it. I'll take that one.

Organiser: Excellent. Welcome to the club, Laura.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Charla de bienvenida a una reserva natural

Hello everyone, and welcome to Blackwater Nature Reserve. My name's Sam, and I'm one of the rangers here. I'll just spend a few minutes explaining how the reserve works and what you can see today. Before describing the individual features of this nature-reserve welcome, it is useful to understand the overall sequence. The information for the nature-reserve welcome follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, beginning with orientation and moving towards more specialised areas. Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the nature-reserve welcome easier to follow. First, a few important rules. We want everyone to enjoy the reserve, but there are a couple of things we don't allow.

I'm afraid dogs are not permitted anywhere on the reserve, even on a lead, because they disturb the ground-nesting birds. And although the lake looks inviting, swimming is strictly forbidden - the water is much deeper and colder than it appears. You are very welcome to cycle, but only on the marked trails, not on the narrow footpaths. Photography is positively encouraged, and picnicking is fine in the designated area near the car park. Some arrangements connected with the nature-reserve welcome may operate differently during the present programme. During the nature-reserve welcome, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time.

Where a condition in the nature-reserve welcome is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. Now, let me tell you about the reserve itself. Blackwater covers around 200 hectares of wetland and forest. It was established in 1987, originally to protect a single rare species of dragonfly, but today it's home to more than a hundred kinds of bird. The most popular attraction is our bird hide, which overlooks the main lake. From there, in winter, you can often see large flocks of geese that migrate here from Scandinavia. As the nature-reserve welcome continues, a shorter route may reach the same principal areas. Within the nature-reserve welcome, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme.

If an alternative becomes necessary during the nature-reserve welcome, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available. Do not try to memorise every detail of the nature-reserve welcome at once. The most important instructions will return when they become relevant. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. If you follow the blue trail, it takes you through the ancient woodland, where some of the oak trees are over four hundred years old. The red trail is longer and leads to the observation tower, which gives you a spectacular view across the whole reserve. Do allow about two hours if you want to complete it.

A final way to follow the nature-reserve welcome is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. Descriptions help you build a mental map, whereas instructions tell you when to move or decide. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. Our visitor centre, just behind me, has a small café and a shop selling maps and guidebooks. There's also an exhibition explaining how the

wetland is managed. Entry to the reserve is free, but we rely on donations, so please give generously if you can. Finally, the reserve closes at dusk, so please make sure you've returned to the car park before the gates are locked. Enjoy your visit, and do come and find me if you have any questions.

If you become uncertain during the nature-reserve welcome, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking. Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence. This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Conversación sobre una presentación de lingüística

Tutor: Right, Maya and Tom, let's talk about your linguistics presentation. Remind me what topic you've chosen.

Maya: We're looking at why some languages become endangered, and what can be done to keep them alive. We were originally going to compare two languages, but we decided to focus on just one - a language called Manx, from the Isle of Man.

Tutor: Before we settle on an interpretation for the linguistics presentation, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Maya: Agreed. For the linguistics presentation, we can state the initial expectation and then test it against each observation. That will make the argument more credible.

Tutor: Interesting choice. Why Manx in particular?

Tom: Well, it's a fascinating case because the last native speaker died in the 1970s, but the language has since been revived. There are now children being brought up speaking it again, which is quite unusual.

Maya: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the linguistics presentation. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Tutor: Yes. The audience needs to know what the design can and cannot establish.

Tutor: It certainly is. So how have you organised your research?

Maya: We started by reading academic articles, but honestly, the most useful material came from interviews with people involved in the revival. Talking to actual speakers gave us insights we couldn't get from books.

Tutor: Another question is whether our categories for the linguistics presentation are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Maya: For the linguistics presentation, let us define the variable before presenting the measurement. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Tutor: I agree - primary sources are invaluable. Now, what's your main argument going to be?

Tom: Our central point is that reviving a language depends less on money than on community enthusiasm. Funding helps, of course, but without a committed community, it simply doesn't work.

Maya: The order of the linguistics presentation presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Tutor: For the linguistics presentation, we can add a linking sentence at each handover and rehearse the transitions.

Tutor: That's a strong, clear thesis. Is there anything you're finding difficult?

Tutor: Our final review of the linguistics presentation should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Maya: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can record the remaining action beside the person responsible for it.

Maya: The hardest part is keeping the presentation short enough. We've got so much material that we keep going over the time limit.

Tutor: That's a common problem. Be ruthless - cut anything that doesn't support your main argument. Now, a few suggestions for improvement. First, I think you should include some audio, so the audience can actually hear what Manx sounds like. That will be far more powerful than just describing it.

Maya: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the linguistics presentation, including the reason for it.

Tutor: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

Tom: Good idea.

Tutor: Second, add a map showing where the language is spoken - people find geography helps them remember. And do check your pronunciation of the place names; get a native speaker to record them if you can. Finally, remember to rehearse the timing at least twice before the actual presentation.

Tutor: Before we finish the linguistics presentation, let us read the argument from the perspective of somebody who did not collect the evidence. Each claim should identify what was observed, how it was measured and which limitation affects the interpretation.

Maya: I will also check that our recommendation follows from the result rather than from what we expected at the beginning. If a sentence sounds stronger than the method allows, we can narrow it without losing the main point.

Tutor: Good. Then the final version will show a clear line from the research question through the evidence to the conclusion.

Maya: Thank you, that's really useful.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: Ecosistemas desérticos

Good morning. Today's lecture is about desert ecosystems - environments that many people imagine to be lifeless, but which are in fact home to a remarkable variety of specially adapted organisms. To place the desert-ecosystem lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it. Within the desert-ecosystem lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through repeated experiments, local adaptations and occasional failures. A simple list of events in the desert-ecosystem lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. First, let's define what we mean by a desert. A desert is usually defined as any region that receives less than 250 millimetres of rainfall a year.

By this definition, deserts cover roughly one third of the Earth's land surface. And, surprisingly, not all deserts are hot - the largest desert in the world is actually Antarctica, which is classified as a desert because it is extremely dry. Evidence for the desert-ecosystem lecture does not come from a single source. Researchers may compare individual cases with broader samples collected over time. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. The central challenge for any desert organism is a shortage of water. Plants have evolved several strategies to cope.

Many, such as the cactus, store water in their thick stems and have leaves reduced to spines to limit evaporation. Others have extremely long roots that reach deep underground to find moisture. A third group survives underground and grows rapidly after the rare rains. Scale is especially important when evaluating the desert-ecosystem lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this desert-ecosystem lecture, no striking individual example should be treated as a universal rule. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful. Animals face the same challenge and have their own adaptations.

Many desert animals are nocturnal, meaning they are active only at night, when temperatures are cooler. The kangaroo rat is a striking example - it can survive its entire life without ever drinking, obtaining all the water it needs from the seeds it eats. Larger animals, such as the camel, can tolerate a significant loss of body water and can go for long periods without drinking at all. It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the desert-ecosystem lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. A conclusion should be as strong as the evidence allows, but no stronger. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together.

The separate examples in the desert-ecosystem lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the desert-ecosystem lecture, returning to those questions will connect evidence gathered at different scales. The conclusion to the desert-ecosystem lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence. Deserts are also

fragile. Because plants grow so slowly, any damage takes a very long time to repair. One of the greatest threats is desertification - the process by which fertile land gradually turns into desert, usually as a result of human activities such as overgrazing by livestock.

Climate change is expected to make many existing deserts even drier in the coming decades. A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the desert-ecosystem lecture less convincing. Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together. Yet deserts also offer opportunities. They receive intense sunshine, which makes them ideal locations for generating solar energy. And scientists study desert organisms in the hope of discovering compounds that could be used in medicine. Far from being empty wastelands, deserts are dynamic systems that deserve our protection.

One final point about the desert-ecosystem lecture concerns the difference between a useful model and a complete explanation. A model selects the relationships that matter most for a particular question, so it can be informative even when it leaves out local variation. Problems arise when that simplification is forgotten and a result from one scale is treated as a rule for every case. The evidence discussed here should therefore be read with its conditions attached: the period observed, the population or material studied, the method used and the uncertainty that remains. Those conditions do not weaken the account; they show exactly where the conclusion is supported and where further observation would be needed.